How Is Mom Doing Today? A Dated Snapshot Worksheet for Your Family

Write down what she does on her own, where she gets a hand, and what she has told you she wants.

“She's about the same” is hard to check a year from now. A page with today's date on it isn't.

Fill this in over a couple of ordinary weeks, not in one sitting. Write what you've seen and what Mom has told you. Where you haven't seen or asked, write “haven't seen” or “haven't asked yet” and leave it.

Then put it somewhere you'll find it again.

Today's date, and who is filling this in

Put the date first. It's what makes this page worth having later.

Her health, as you know it today

The diagnoses and ongoing conditions you know about, the medications she takes, any hospital stay during the past year, and who told you each thing. Write “not sure” where you're not sure.

FOR EXAMPLE High blood pressure, and arthritis in both knees. Mom told me. Pills morning and night; I don't know the names. No hospital stays this year.

What she does on her own

An ordinary week: bathing and dressing, meals, housework, shopping, bills and mail, getting to appointments. Only what someone has seen or she has told you.

FOR EXAMPLE Drives to church and to the grocery store, in the daytime. Cooks most nights. Pays her bills by check at the kitchen table.

Where she gets a hand, and from whom

The help that's already happening, including the small things people have stopped counting, and roughly when each began.

FOR EXAMPLE Karen has driven her to the eye doctor since last spring. The boy next door mows the lawn. I fill her pill box when I visit, most Sundays.

What is different from a year ago

Changes in her memory, in how she gets around, or in anything else. Write what you saw and roughly when, not what you think it means.

FOR EXAMPLE Stopped driving after dark around March; her own choice. Asked me twice in one visit which day the plumber was coming.

What she has told you she wants

Her own words about where she'd want to live, who she'd want involved, and what matters most to her. If nobody has asked, write “haven't asked yet.”

FOR EXAMPLE “I'm staying in this house. Your father built that porch.” Hasn't said who she'd want involved in decisions.

What this shows you

Three things: how Mom is managing today, the help that's already in place, and what she has said she wants. With a date on it, it's something to compare against later. It doesn't show whether she needs more help, or what kind. Nothing here adds up to a score or a level, or is medical, legal, financial or tax advice. Questions about her health, her memory or her medications go to her doctor or her pharmacist.

Ready for the next step?

You've put today on paper, with a date on it. The care interview picks up from there: it walks you through Mom's situation area by area so nothing important is overlooked, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›
